WEEK 11 · LECTURE L2 OF 3 · UNIT IV

HR as Digital Change Agent

Capability, mandate and credibility, the politics of transformation, and GL-1003 as the test.

Part 1 Capability, mandate and credibility; reskilling HR itself

Part 2 The politics of transformation: coalitions and stakeholders

Part 3 The long arc of change

Read Scully-Russ (2019), the change-agent argument

R K Singh · Senior Professor, Department of Commerce · Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi · DSEH001 · M.Com. PGCF 2025

PART 1 · HR'S OWN EXPOSURE

GL-1003 Sunil Mehta: a reskilling case, not a redundancy case

Role family	Sample (full scale)	Automation risk	Skill gap	6B choice
HR Officer	11 (88)	0.35	0.9	Build
HR Manager	24 (192)	0.20	0.5	Build

READ IT

Sunil is not at high risk of replacement. He is at high risk of being left without the skills the new model needs. Source: Workforce_Planning.

PART 1 · CAPABILITY, MANDATE, CREDIBILITY

Three things a change agent needs

Capability

Data literacy, technology judgment, change skill. HR must reskill itself first.

Mandate

Formal authority from the CHRO and the Board to change processes across functions.

Credibility

Earned by early, visible wins that matter to store managers, not only to HR.

SCULLY-RUSS (2019)

Industry 4.0 makes HR development central: skills, professional identity and workers' agency, not only technology adoption.

Map the stakeholders before you need them

Stakeholder	What they care about	What they can block
CFO	Cost, return, risk	Budget
Store managers	Staffing, sales, time	Daily adoption
IT	Security, integration, workload	Technical delivery
Frontline staff	Ease, language, fairness	Use, through workarounds
Gig partners	Earnings, voice	Retention of the delivery network

Going deeper: the theory underneath change agency

The next slides set out Mitchell, Agle and Wood on stakeholder salience, Lewin's force field, Kotter's eight errors, and Pfeffer on power: what each claims, how it works, where it breaks, and what it means at GreenLeaf.

THEORY IN DEPTH · MITCHELL, AGLE AND WOOD (1997)

Which stakeholders get attention

THE CORE IDEA

Stakeholder salience depends on three attributes: power, legitimacy and urgency.

HOW IT WORKS

Those with all three are definitive stakeholders; those with only legitimacy are often ignored.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Salience is perceived by managers, so it can be misjudged.

AT GREENLEAF

Gig partners have legitimacy and urgency but little power. A fair strategy gives them weight anyway.

THEORY IN DEPTH · LEWIN (1951)

Force field analysis

THE CORE IDEA

Any situation is held in balance by driving forces and restraining forces.

HOW IT WORKS

Change happens more easily by reducing restraining forces than by pushing harder.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

A simplification: forces interact and change over time.

AT GREENLEAF

Removing a restraint (no Telugu interface) may do more than another push (a mandate to use the app).

THEORY IN DEPTH · KOTTER (1995)

Eight errors that make transformation fail

THE CORE IDEA

From studying change efforts, Kotter listed common errors, starting with not creating enough urgency.

HOW IT WORKS

Others include no powerful coalition, under-communicating the vision, declaring victory too soon, and not anchoring change in culture.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Evidence is drawn from Kotter's consulting cases rather than systematic study.

AT GREENLEAF

Declaring victory at go-live is GreenLeaf's most likely error. Adoption, not launch, is the finish line.

THEORY IN DEPTH · PFEFFER (1992)

Getting things done needs power

THE CORE IDEA

In organizations, change requires understanding and using power, not only good ideas.

HOW IT WORKS

Map interests and influence, build alliances, and time moves to when support is strongest.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Power can be used for narrow ends; the theory is descriptive, not a license.

AT GREENLEAF A good analytics case fails without allies among store managers and in finance.

TAKEAWAYS

Three things to carry out of this lecture

1

HR must reskill itself before it can lead others.

2

Map stakeholders by power, legitimacy and urgency.

3

Reduce restraining forces rather than pushing harder.

NEXT Writing the Board Memo.